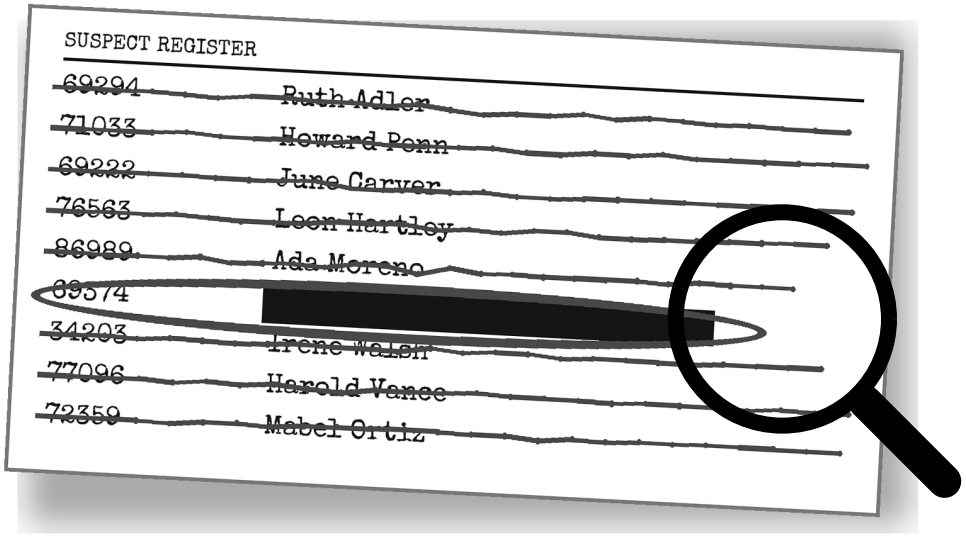
A LARGE PRINT MURDER MYSTERY PUZZLE BOOK

CROSS OUT THE KILLER

Death on the Magnolia Queen



BONUS CASE

800 SUSPECTS · 10 CLUES · 3 TESTS · 1 KILLER

FUN BOOKS
PUBLISHER



Cross Out the Killer: Death on the Magnolia Queen

A Large Print Murder Mystery Puzzle Book

Bonus Case

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This is a work of fiction. The story, the places, the events and the organizations in it are imaginary and are not connected with any real event, place, organization or person. The names in the suspect register were built from public U.S. Census name lists and paired at random; any resemblance to real people is a coincidence.

The case has been checked by computer: there is exactly one killer, every clue is needed to narrow the register down to the finalists, and the answer is never printed in the book.

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WELCOME, DETECTIVE

Thank you for opening this case. Somewhere in these pages, among 800 names, one person committed a crime, and you are the only detective on the case.

Every clue is fair, a checkpoint after every clue keeps you on track, and the answer is never printed, so nothing can spoil the surprise. Take it one clue at a time. There is no rush.

Happy sleuthing,
the team at Fun Books Publisher

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HOW TO PLAY

You are the detective. A crime has been committed at the Magnolia Queen, and the killer is one of the **800 people** in the Suspect Register, which comes right after the clues.

1. Read the case. The story tells you what happened.

2. Take the clues one at a time. Each clue tells you one true fact about the killer, and exactly what to cross out.

3. Go through the whole register and cross out every suspect who does not match the clue. Draw one straight line through the name, so you can still read it later.

4. Check your work. After every clue there is a **checkpoint**. If your numbers match, carry on. If not, look back over that clue before you move on.

5. Part One ends with 3 finalists. In **Part Two** you study the police case files to find out which of them is the killer. Part Two has its own instructions.

6. Check your answer with the Verdict Code at the end of the book.

You will need: a pen or a fine marker, good light, and a cup of something nice. A ruler or a bookmark helps you keep your place on the page.

Take your time. This is not a race. Most detectives solve a few clues a day.

A QUICK PRACTICE CASE

Here is a tiny register with only six suspects, already solved, so you can see how it works before you start the real case.

TICKET	NAME	AGE	CROSSED OUT BY
~~41207~~	~~Ann Lee~~	~~34~~	Clue 1
~~52818~~	~~Bob Hart~~	~~67~~	Clue 3
~~63544~~	~~Ida Moss~~	~~45~~	Clue 2
~~70132~~	~~Tom Reyes~~	~~52~~	Clue 3
~~81936~~	~~Eve Cole~~	~~28~~	Clue 1
90217	Joe Park	71	**THE KILLER**

Clue 1. The killer is 40 years old or older. Cross out Ann (34) and Eve (28).

Clue 2. The killer's ticket number contains the digit 1. Cross out Ida, because her ticket, 63544, has no 1 in it.

Clue 3. The killer's ticket number is odd. Cross out Bob (52818) and Tom (70132). Only Joe Park is left.

That is all there is to it. The real case works exactly the same way, just with a great many more suspects. Good luck, detective.

CASE FILE

DEATH ON THE MAGNOLIA QUEEN

Every summer the Magnolia Queen, the last great paddle steamer on the Mississippi, sails out of Natchez for her famous Saturday night dinner cruise: a jazz band, crab cakes, and eight hundred passengers in their best clothes.

This year was Captain Silas Merrow's last cruise. After forty years at the wheel, he had promised to end the night by opening the ship's old safe in front of everyone, and to tell who had really sold him the "lost" riverboat log that made the Magnolia Queen famous.

At twenty past nine, the first mate found the captain dead in his cabin. He had been struck from behind. The safe was open, and the old log was gone.

Every passenger had a numbered boarding ticket, and the purser's register lists all eight hundred of them: ticket number, name and age. The boat had not touched the shore since it left Natchez. The killer was still on board.

This short bonus case works exactly like the books. In **Part One**, the clues will help you rule out suspects until only three **finalists** are left. In **Part Two**, the purser's files will tell you which of the three did it.

DETECTIVE'S NOTEBOOK

Check off each clue when you have finished it. It helps when you come back another day.

- ☐ Clue 1 _____
- ☐ Clue 2 _____
- ☐ Clue 3 _____
- ☐ Clue 4 _____
- ☐ Clue 5 _____
- ☐ Clue 6 _____
- ☐ Clue 7 _____
- ☐ Clue 8 _____
- ☐ Clue 9 _____
- ☐ Clue 10 _____

MY NOTES

PART ONE: THE CLUES

EVIDENCE #1

Clue 1 of 10

The killer had a first name stitched onto a souvenir napkin at the embroidery table, and the needle broke halfway through. The half-napkin left in the Captain's Cabin shows only one clear letter of the first name: an E.

The killer's FIRST name contains the letter E.

What to do: Cross out every suspect whose first name has no letter E.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, page 19 should have **25** names left and page 28 should have **28**. To check any other page, use the Checking Tables on page 29.

EVIDENCE #2

Clue 2 of 10

Boarding tickets with a 1 in the number were printed on the old machine, which punches a star-shaped hole; all the others got a round hole. A corner of the killer's ticket, too small to show any numbers, was found under the captain's desk. Its hole is round.

The killer's ticket number does not contain the digit 1.

What to do: Cross out every suspect whose ticket number has a 1 anywhere in it.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, page 19 should have **15** names left and page 21 should have **18**. To check any other page, use the Checking Tables on page 29.

EVIDENCE #3

Clue 3 of 10

The "Young at Heart" dance contest was open only to passengers aged 55 or younger, and every dancer wore a numbered paper badge. The killer's dance badge was found torn off by the cabin door. The number on it is smudged beyond reading.

The killer is 55 years old or younger.

What to do: Cross out every suspect older than 55.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **123** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #4

Clue 4 of 10

The gangway scanner could not read tickets with an 8 in the number, so those passengers had their ticket stamped by hand in purple ink. The same corner of the killer's ticket has no purple ink on it.

> **The killer's ticket number does not contain the digit 8.**
>
> **What to do:** Cross out every suspect whose ticket number has an 8 anywhere in it.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **69** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #5

Clue 5 of 10

The killer signed the captain's guest book for the safe opening. A glass of iced tea was knocked over it, and only one letter of the last name can still be read: an A.

> **The killer's LAST name contains the letter A.**
>
> **What to do:** Cross out every suspect whose last name has no letter A.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **41** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #6

Clue 6 of 10

The purser stamps a last name on every brass luggage tag, from a box of metal letters that has been missing its S for years; names with an S get a paper tag instead. The killer's luggage tag, left on the captain's chair, is brass, and the name has been scratched off.

> **The killer's LAST name does not contain the letter S.**
>
> **What to do:** Cross out every suspect whose last name contains the letter S.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **26** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #7

Clue 7 of 10

Passengers with a ticket ending in 0, 1, 2, 3 or 4 boarded through the lower gangway and got a blue wristband; everyone else boarded through the upper gangway and got a yellow one. A snapped blue wristband was found by the open safe, torn off the killer's wrist in a hurry.

> **The LAST digit of the killer's ticket is 0, 1, 2, 3 or 4.**
>
> **What to do:** Cross out every suspect whose ticket ends in 5, 6, 7, 8 or 9.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **12** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #8

Clue 8 of 10

The purser's seating cards have six printed boxes for a last name, and longer names run along the bottom edge. The killer's seating card was found in the cabin, smudged by the rain, but there is nothing written along the bottom edge.

The killer's LAST name has 6 letters or fewer.

What to do: Cross out every suspect whose last name has more than 6 letters.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **8** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #9

Clue 9 of 10

The bar prints each guest's first name on a cocktail stirrer, and the printer had no letter O all night, so any name with an O got a plain stirrer. The killer's stirrer, left in the captain's glass, is printed, although the river damp has washed the letters away.

The killer's FIRST name does not contain the letter O.

What to do: Cross out every suspect whose first name contains the letter O.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **5** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #10

Clue 10 of 10

A scrap of the killer's ticket was caught in the hinge of the safe door. Only one digit survives on it: a 7.

The killer's ticket number contains the digit 7.

What to do: Cross out every suspect whose ticket number has no 7 in it.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **3** suspects should be left in the whole register. These are your **finalists**. Write their names and ticket numbers in the box on page 30, then turn to Part Two.

TICKET	NAME	AGE
10076	Greta Holley	70
10136	Allen Million	72
10282	Kendrick Murphy	47
10370	Alisha Hancock	29
10409	George Broome	69
10506	Rhonda Sangster	33
10546	April Ruiz	81
10602	Freddie Beard	37
10826	Kathleen Bussey	38
10977	William Brown	22
11155	Angela Reed	82
11314	Orville Webster	64
11332	Jeremy Templin	67
11379	Peter Rector	38
11440	Richard Weeks	28
11565	Spencer Cheshire	67
11681	Tom Bergstrom	19
11718	Paulette Morey	55
11886	Hubert Parker	18
12114	Jason Egan	70
12167	Joshua Cooper	68
12184	Charles Weaver	25
12602	Royal Henke	20
12646	Blanca Hunt	73
12653	Eleanor Roybal	75
12829	Douglas Anthony	85
12911	Joanne Clayton	31
13053	Bridget Falk	59
13153	Mary Townsend	58
13201	Rodney Ayala	72
13296	Fred Knott	77
13354	Sadie Figueroa	78
13495	Maryann Bigelow	71
13656	Edwin Kirkendall	76
13921	Jaclyn Wolfe	91
13927	Charles Cobb	36
14152	Jimmie Navarro	61
14163	Sandra Meunier	64
14171	Jerry Curry	42
14202	Kurt Gallagher	29
14323	Isaac Rubio	57
14325	Mae Lima	38
14400	George Purdy	20
14779	Benjamin Escobar	18
14973	Suzanne Arenas	55
15006	Jonathan Parada	72
15069	Alan Reynoso	42
15078	Alan Chase	32
15103	Anna Moody	33
15328	Anthony Loos	18
15337	Sarah Terrell	52
15358	Cornell Mello	70
15396	Harvey Branch	67
15621	Sidney Blakely	22

TICKET	NAME	AGE
15630	Mia Frazier	48
15743	Cameron Levy	71
15744	Deborah Stuart	42
15796	Derek Beers	32
16000	Willie Gallegos	63
16243	Marcus Wallace	77
16252	Jennifer Crozier	23
16411	Andrew Rhodes	73
16504	Grace Renaud	73
16629	Monica Edwards	36
16737	Jeremy Cano	69
16819	Oscar Fink	83
17164	Jessica Perkins	18
17273	Nathan Cedeno	37
17475	Benjamin Sigler	32
17758	Peter Dietz	32
17804	Susanna Lasky	85
17819	Wilma Cooper	79
18142	Gerald Barba	56
18249	Rogelio Bozarth	30
18350	Scott Goff	62
18997	Alex Draughn	34
19198	Hugh Cadet	92
19326	Raymond Turco	46
19663	Jamie Wayland	29
19753	Melody Ingersoll	90
19829	Amelia Beavers	59
19932	John Arneson	27
19951	Kevin Carman	69
20030	Juan Binns	47
20092	Jeanette Spry	88
20322	Alice Granger	80
20605	Dudley Cobb	89
20703	Ethan Mendez	65
20805	Justin Zepeda	63
21191	Tabitha Rudisill	58
21502	Brian Kimmel	87
21566	Kathleen Alfaro	28
21670	Beverly Reynaga	44
21929	Lester Edge	63
22034	Taylor Baptiste	50
22106	Flora Gould	86
22171	Gail Boykin	28
22205	Inez Rivas	26
22263	Eloy Sutter	48
22311	Arthur Hussain	57
22336	Dominic Palacios	57
22457	Colette Pitts	31
22524	Julie Bosch	60
22603	Christine Govea	72
22785	Spencer Persaud	33
22899	Wesley Kuhn	31
22919	David Freeze	85
22991	Frank Maeda	28

TICKET	NAME	AGE
22994	Donna Stovall	41
23328	Kyle Barbieri	72
23370	Frances Santiago	27
23411	Patrick Strunk	32
23553	Mary Isaac	39
23809	Lloyd Boswell	79
23813	Miguel Pokorny	78
24099	Brenda Stover	84
24125	Lillian Galvan	30
24174	Karen Ramos	53
24267	Burton Rosales	54
24286	Geneva Dunn	79
24379	Trenton Pittman	59
24442	Reynaldo Scales	19
24585	Tammy Kinnear	29
24970	Curtis Frost	46
25323	Valerie Olivas	57
25476	Eugenia Creech	26
25527	Jefferson Puig	68
25609	Amanda Ewing	77
25675	Don Renaud	80
25689	Ahmad Doyle	22
26046	Caroline Mora	85
26064	Sylvia Manzo	91
26309	Alisha Frazee	25
26337	Helen Maxwell	23
26436	Archie Guzman	57
26484	Wade Demko	54
26565	Desmond Hocker	26
26774	Candace Carbajal	19
26795	Barbara Geib	19
26890	Clarence Beck	44
26949	Beulah Burch	54
26953	Vernon Spann	45
27017	Edwin Chewning	44
27080	Sarah Arsenault	73
27162	Alan Alves	84
27177	Roxanne Fleck	71
27255	Rogelio Craven	74
27466	Delmar Frierson	69
27675	Ricky Gadsden	90
27860	Charles Montano	74
28084	Alfonso Hartman	27
28282	Salvador Reed	88
28294	Gilbert Graziano	77
28298	Anna Overmyer	32
28448	Freddie Genova	48
28563	Cole Bugg	91
28708	Meredith Newby	24
28730	Marcella Cicero	20
28825	Doyle Shankar	82
28872	Nadia Godfrey	18
28984	Douglas Barlow	46
29026	Lydia Vasquez	64

TICKET	NAME	AGE
29158	Bridget Boone	35
29723	Jordan Janney	22
29936	Jamal Hempel	40
29955	Laurie Copeland	66
30011	Yesenia Haddix	43
30019	Tom Nussbaum	43
30057	Jarrod Wells	70
30319	Gail Moncada	89
30811	Juanita Reeder	55
30903	Stacy Kellogg	18
31006	Audrey Arenas	45
31095	Daphne Simeone	79
31218	Mary Webb	78
31461	Carroll Felix	57
31498	Carol Gordon	85
31658	Juan Cole	46
31703	Erika Aldrich	36
31726	Bertha Patterson	51
31927	Tracy Wolfe	88
31985	Cindy Butler	86
32052	Roy Suggs	72
32090	Darlene Iglesias	70
32116	Walter Eldridge	77
32159	Priscilla Banda	38
32163	Jason Hageman	38
32235	Roland Coffey	85
32706	Vernon Casarez	69
32770	Abby Kopp	39
32943	Regina Hotchkiss	36
32948	David Yoder	69
33037	Orville Emig	48
33066	Susan Chacon	43
33092	Melinda Copeland	65
33197	Virgil Gilliland	38
33274	Deborah Tune	62
33410	Tina Rangel	48
33566	Gabriel Gifford	36
33749	Ethan Leger	18
33808	Randy Trinh	37
33864	John Lindquist	50
33871	Harold Staats	44
33992	Jolene Bozeman	33
34022	Ruth Bell	40
34077	Tabitha Sloan	45
34128	Veronica Whipple	57
34433	Lydia Heidt	38
34488	Flossie Burns	66
34779	Trevor Resendiz	56
34788	Phyllis Luna	64
34926	Amanda Pike	42
35127	Catalina Leon	61
35273	Robin Mehl	65
35432	Leah Paredes	18
35471	Boyd Caudle	63

TICKET	NAME	AGE
35496	Clement Trahan	42
35512	Isaac Jardine	46
35532	Reginald Hooks	60
35587	Jarrod Monk	74
35703	Michelle Soucy	59
36009	Misty Enderle	83
36036	Alvaro Yoder	22
36053	Paul George	46
36113	Beatrice Nunez	73
36213	Howard Fuerst	51
36317	Genaro Carr	64
36346	Sidney Hornsby	53
36351	Heather Dearman	51
36415	Bruce Cortez	68
36435	Mattie Greenman	37
36501	Lori Munoz	36
36609	Diane Mateo	64
36633	Heidi Knowles	57
36906	Ramiro Treadway	34
36925	Roger Godoy	61
37199	Georgette Pryor	36
37217	Stacy Higgins	23
37435	Renee Robinson	86
37573	Eric Todd	34
37791	Robert Ponce	62
38060	Simon Aparicio	71
38065	Harvey Frisbie	19
38128	Jason Goodman	25
38142	Nelda Bonham	42
38336	Robert Hansen	88
38392	Danny Zamudio	19
38395	Ebony Bode	73
38450	Bruce Simmons	57
38594	Ted Camacho	48
38653	Dolores Lyons	29
38705	Isidro Berg	41
38797	Lena Calkins	56
38919	Leland Eversole	29
38973	Inez Carlson	61
39048	Jamie Egan	38
39074	Barbara Adams	73
39173	Peter Huerta	43
39184	Beatrice Webb	48
39203	Byron Martinez	21
39267	Miriam Beatty	85
39305	Orlando Aylward	62
39328	Carlos Britton	30
39465	Jolene Colon	25
39521	Graham Kaiser	70
39543	Adam Marquez	62
39636	Misty Ingram	65
39669	Jamie Brewer	86
39672	Alton Grimaldo	91
39739	Minerva Robles	20

TICKET	NAME	AGE
39816	Vicki Herring	27
39840	Vivian Tostado	92
39863	Dominique Braden	18
39880	Spencer Robledo	89
39896	Meredith Cole	81
40058	Gail Jaeger	45
40083	Vera Huey	37
40185	Wayne Colon	51
40261	Jill Stansbury	38
40345	Paige Burton	76
40366	Kenneth Jones	19
40374	Marion Dudley	43
40473	Yvonne Clarkson	65
40485	Curtis Glaze	85
40638	Leroy Burns	78
40660	Todd Hardin	29
40929	George Wagner	37
41132	Carrie Jasso	80
41519	Elsie Nunez	19
41549	Sam Weinstock	73
41662	Juan Ortega	59
41681	Alice Hurley	78
41985	Norbert Tobin	37
42126	James Romero	51
42183	Nettie Higbee	33
42592	Conrad Flores	47
42754	Sam Roberts	27
42888	Brian Reimann	32
43052	Regina Drewry	90
43125	Conrad Romero	90
43145	Alma Jones	92
43168	Gloria Zelaya	49
43367	Anna Rushing	83
43385	Stacie Camargo	63
43476	April Soileau	52
43648	Jimmy Hatch	31
43649	Jarrod Enriquez	37
44112	Darius Bryant	88
44201	Ruth Perlman	48
44287	Matt Temple	28
44501	Rita Alonso	69
44559	Michael Hazelton	72
44649	Sam Lin	80
44671	Omar Womack	22
44728	Frieda Coleman	60
45086	Rafael Petrucci	33
45129	Jesus Higgins	88
45218	Herman Orcutt	73
45569	Brandi Bradford	55
45715	Dorothy Wade	49
45750	Kurt Wojtowicz	76
45898	Jackie Ervin	89
45946	Mia Bode	77
46101	Vince Crozier	46

TICKET	NAME	AGE
46189	Virginia Greco	19
46479	Leila Aguirre	92
46511	Federico Hardy	57
46633	Gordon Sunday	88
46699	Wilma Canada	81
46751	Wade Llewellyn	37
46754	Eileen Simon	71
46791	Rachel Mills	47
46802	Mike Conrad	62
46952	Sue Rogers	26
47156	Erika Broussard	83
47223	Everett Blakely	73
47224	Wilbur Arellano	74
47363	Brandi Purdie	56
47474	Caleb Minor	61
47480	Yvette Marler	47
47494	Danny Heinrich	19
47817	Bobbie North	68
47941	Melissa Girard	86
48043	Teresa Simpson	49
48144	Jesse Hernandez	57
48177	Lilia Rector	83
48222	Dixie Ngo	40
48278	Sharon Qualls	69
48283	Wilfred Reno	82
48326	Lucille Rendon	31
48507	Cheryl Applegate	53
48509	Darrell Matthews	47
48556	Alicia Fuller	31
48615	Madge Lott	66
48641	William Walden	39
48741	Katrina Patel	69
49086	Leah Elgin	40
49089	Lucy Phifer	52
49226	Alicia Goff	91
49251	Leon Finnegan	69
49302	Arturo Iorio	37
49515	Omar Aparicio	21
49913	Rudolph Bynum	29
50165	Roman Enright	78
50232	Hector Torres	75
50291	Percy Spates	65
50479	Debra Hartley	69
50500	Roman Emmons	30
50531	Yolanda Kania	58
50657	Joseph Draughn	46
50689	Paul Zuniga	46
50912	Benjamin Pinto	74
50931	Suzanne Courtney	22
51005	Devon Schofield	76
51057	Donna Roebuck	25
51164	Robert Saleh	75
51327	Sylvia Hewitt	58
51382	Lisa Dietz	24

TICKET	NAME	AGE
51467	Harriet Newell	23
51580	Melody Brochu	74
51734	Robert Crabb	28
51776	Norbert Giddings	92
51871	Norma Curiel	85
52109	Pauline Arneson	57
52293	Logan Losee	45
52425	Rafael Arnold	72
52476	Jamal Driver	47
52516	Marjorie Loomis	68
52660	Quentin Daniels	26
52691	Nicholas Perkins	65
52954	Amber Kondo	31
53098	Bobbie Foley	54
53117	Herbert Hagedorn	85
53234	Luciano Ruppel	86
53364	Sylvia Horvath	67
53539	Elaine Turnbull	92
53593	Mary Galligan	59
53617	Kim Armstrong	69
53651	Nicole Kersey	77
53800	Shirley Stroud	75
53970	Daniel Pantoja	64
54191	Heidi Henderson	81
54203	Daniel Morgan	30
54240	Ruben Livesay	66
54257	Luke Elkins	56
54297	Richard Bell	90
54342	Sylvester Stokes	39
54375	April Zamarripa	66
54462	Guadalupe Mateo	75
54545	Kurt Matheson	26
54651	Paul Boyd	86
54821	Lucille Camp	80
54922	Irving Chang	77
54962	Kendrick Scales	82
55037	Jolene Brim	58
55066	Michael Silva	74
55169	Frieda Markovich	38
55258	Candace Parker	29
55333	Juanita Murphree	33
55508	Abby Westervelt	78
55534	Mona Bollman	73
55802	Lloyd Dyck	58
55815	Stella Kelsch	57
55825	Nancy Allen	73
55912	Sarah Clegg	34
55934	Lizzie Brister	64
56167	Randall Robinson	22
56264	Alma Bolster	44
56414	Nikki Behrens	35
56823	Gail Cavanaugh	22
56940	Delbert Rios	89
56955	David Hutchinson	45

TICKET	NAME	AGE
57141	Truman Flowers	74
57382	Roy Arroyo	18
57478	Barbara Griffin	19
57480	Lloyd Seabrook	68
57599	Vicki Balboa	85
57715	Sharon Milne	46
57740	Nicole Diaz	31
57816	Richard Rizvi	73
57977	Pedro Abrams	23
58019	Kevin Oxley	85
58035	Ivy Fonseca	37
58224	Valerie Boring	62
58295	Janis Monge	47
58312	Edna Britton	70
58541	Jill Woodard	58
58547	Sharon Woodring	58
58618	Willie Loomis	66
58634	Maria Macias	47
58804	Glenn Nelson	34
58929	Luciano Wren	62
58964	Todd Heim	39
59224	Doreen Harris	51
59291	Betty Messina	45
59324	Donna Ruiz	87
59341	Velma Levin	52
59596	Craig Rafferty	62
59953	Heather Aguilar	73
60034	Cruz Boone	65
60047	Ted Granger	89
60229	Willard Slagle	61
60387	Naomi Winchester	26
60899	Lloyd Moore	70
61180	Diane Adair	73
61418	Tina Porter	45
61591	Harold Barnum	36
61987	Basil Ponder	73
62193	Ralph Mann	62
62302	Amber Branch	32
62367	Victor Rincon	49
62554	Deirdre Phillips	74
62638	Joyce Madigan	29
62712	Tammy Irwin	58
62839	Wilbur Alcala	18
63095	Julianne Nabors	77
63112	Pedro Lee	74
63115	Marcella Gregory	84
63235	Eva Cherry	68
63249	Milton Branham	43
63474	Amelia Mohamed	91
63614	Jimmy Tweedy	40
63778	Willard Hess	52
63792	Patsy Santoyo	45
63944	Barbara Davidson	67
64353	Lydia Olivieri	31

TICKET	NAME	AGE
64448	Celeste Johnson	84
64477	Herman Rubio	48
64490	Sue Presley	76
64700	Emmett Sanchez	83
65171	Doris Hyde	31
65193	Anna Gerstner	51
65325	Jonas Coelho	77
65347	Marissa Hannum	90
65455	Pauline Ragland	84
65492	Randall Medley	23
65519	Evelyn Watkins	19
65603	Hunter Bradshaw	20
65654	Brock Diehl	77
65659	Darcy Patton	28
65662	Lisa Holub	35
65686	Donald Crawford	77
65715	Erika Jaramillo	35
65734	Ethel Migliore	37
65872	Shanna Shannon	51
65884	Vincent Osorio	46
66097	Hazel Bolin	79
66226	Olga Sayles	60
66287	Ruth Plank	38
66429	Louis Bedford	68
66709	Felicia Mason	58
66839	Gavin Glass	71
66986	Joyce Wrobel	82
67055	Clara Reynolds	56
67067	Nathan Trapani	18
67187	Katie Wisniewski	58
67227	Ruben Cain	24
67340	Lori Gibbs	75
67500	Carroll Godfrey	43
67518	Augustine Wesley	42
67869	Darrell Ulrich	46
67950	Jeffrey Norman	40
68353	Jonathan Marrufo	57
68591	Melissa Hudak	27
68603	Marcus Fowler	35
68610	Edna Chen	87
68716	Javier Dugger	58
68766	Ashley Barco	75
68953	Ernestine Sawyer	67
68986	Loretta Foti	25
69193	Theodore Switzer	76
69245	Wanda Zerbe	42
69341	Casey Choi	26
69483	Omar Griffin	45
69531	Tamara Shaffer	87
69656	Genaro Meehan	32
69712	Byron Beringer	64
70023	Dawn Glaser	26
70037	Nicholas Aranda	80
70039	Shannon Wooster	22

TICKET	NAME	AGE
70057	Carol Bhatia	71
70187	Ben Spaulding	25
70206	Elmo Simmons	20
70254	Vera Soriano	60
70308	Roland Friend	51
70397	Kari Aranda	75
70411	Danny Ervin	44
70443	Laurie Banks	39
70504	Fred Ramirez	51
70556	Amy Postma	84
70611	Grant Moreno	91
70790	Claudette Newman	78
71136	Meredith Nagy	29
71329	Nadia Hamm	60
71366	Irene Cobian	73
71406	Derrick Bilodeau	29
71604	Gloria Bertrand	48
71758	Nadia Kennedy	40
71772	Gloria Root	44
71851	Emmett Wright	77
71948	Reed Claudio	33
72053	Dolores Cusumano	36
72197	Hugh Alexander	56
72516	Janice Guevara	29
72548	Sylvia Navarrete	28
72639	Brenda Southard	92
72710	Warren Arroyo	75
72746	Alfred Broadhead	68
72897	Oscar Janney	83
73010	Emily Austin	87
73069	Sherry Randle	78
73370	Henry Amaya	43
73431	Adele Hurtado	30
73567	Jesse Pledger	87
73618	Taylor Weaver	21
73641	Melinda Grant	28
73673	Maurice Gramajo	60
73726	Ruth Truong	38
73855	Zachary Fletcher	83
73894	Penny Tripp	83
73900	Travis Marroquin	20
73928	Claudia Adorno	74
73939	Kim Walker	89
74053	Jamie Yohe	21
74072	Leonor Midkiff	46
74167	Jolene Amin	34
74173	Brittany Swinney	51
74227	Gustavo Rider	24
74359	Brian Lane	86
74477	Betty Emig	35
74760	Wendy Patel	61
74942	Roger Weinberger	48
74947	Jared Crabtree	81
74968	Michael Millsap	86

TICKET	NAME	AGE
75216	Mildred Tillman	41
75329	Vincent Mata	37
75488	Isidro Carlisle	54
75520	Hunter Ransom	59
75611	Keith Steinberg	91
75661	Michael Bonham	71
75683	Jimmie Hess	55
75865	Celia Carnahan	63
75914	Alan Ngo	91
75996	Madeline Brazell	46
76243	Josefina Warren	20
76364	Cedric Harper	69
76468	Julie Schofield	28
76545	Sidney Boggess	57
76550	Morris Dolce	75
76768	Ricky Berg	92
77022	Lance Mooney	62
77119	Jeannine Graff	20
77192	Forrest Mullins	66
77245	Rebekah Pena	74
77318	Mattie Orcutt	72
77540	Pamela Lyles	76
77565	Jeremy Whitaker	28
77621	James Ayala	40
77652	Humberto Rahman	32
77675	Lauren Mooney	46
77936	Laura Hatfield	49
77954	Daniel Carlson	56
77972	Betty Ashford	80
77980	Tina Craft	37
78061	John Hyde	24
78179	Lawrence Ogle	36
78438	Herman Gordon	64
78550	Suzette Thompson	20
78673	Naomi Olivares	61
78905	Stewart Solis	48
79142	Renee Duffield	91
79265	Joyce Boggs	80
79274	Jeremy Piazza	76
79377	Adele Tocco	73
79446	Kelly Marsh	18
79543	Stacy Pecina	25
79684	Maurice Mathis	50
80082	Jason Greenfield	41
80107	James Eads	18
80160	Melvin Briscoe	23
80228	Clyde Duda	19
80238	Bradley Morgan	55
80345	Colette Strauss	69
80535	Gregorio Spivey	56
80662	Rosemary Paramo	25
80768	Omar Bailey	85
80899	Crystal Phelps	22
80967	Noemi Dugger	77

TICKET	NAME	AGE
81007	Johnny Ahmed	45
81023	Clarence Hurd	51
81039	Dominic Schaaf	61
81371	Julie Robertson	64
81453	Clyde Harms	37
81717	Ethel Frederick	58
81755	Debra Leonhardt	77
81840	Rebekah Yamasaki	57
81941	Alma Bailey	80
81953	Homer Sizemore	39
82143	Sonny Cornejo	45
82203	Louis Phifer	43
82240	Claudia Lirette	39
82328	Andrew Schwab	70
82391	Carmen Schorr	68
82405	Fidel Lopez	54
82512	Marissa Ridenour	75
82953	Stacy Stover	81
83022	Maggie Etienne	20
83240	Debra Hatfield	55
83252	Muriel Polanco	89
83254	Thelma Cabezas	75
83351	Lisa Umana	27
83523	Charlene Gooch	21
83571	Kimberly Magill	23
83773	Brad Tabor	65
83854	Peter Guerra	77
83878	Roy Stafford	43
83963	Rebecca Nieto	88
83989	Loren Bucio	48
84608	Janice Collins	45
84678	Rodrigo Fry	28
84821	Larry Bushong	84
84835	Micah Bernal	36
85052	Glenda Ibarra	61
85111	Fred Alonso	83
85247	Kimberly Anand	72
85297	Rufus Asuncion	80
85500	Helen Trent	57
85559	Blake Morrow	71
85625	Sherry Eriksen	39
85685	David Candelaria	83
85796	Audrey Robles	18
85871	Lillian Early	80
85933	Reginald Grant	53
86260	Dennis Tutt	57
86345	Keith Guenther	62
86762	Martha Rainey	90
87221	Amy Lightfoot	77
87442	Edwin Chandler	66
87473	Chris Khalil	80
87500	Morris Tisdale	59
88063	Levi Park	30
88139	Latoya Laboy	42

TICKET	NAME	AGE
88365	Bobbie Chism	87
88382	Jennifer Goetz	90
88521	Myrtle Begley	91
88915	Royal Leavitt	76
89004	Maggie Palmer	32
89301	Lucinda Chen	70
89406	Sally Baltazar	37
89433	Meredith Crabb	92
89819	Damian Klein	85
89969	Elvira Neal	32
90064	Randolph Brekke	53
90234	Paul Silver	79
90805	Paige Hornsby	22
90895	Lucille Schwartz	27
91092	Mia Sweet	59
91189	Howard Eskridge	46
91253	Tammy Locke	60
91309	Aurora Sauls	69
91332	Effie Turner	88
91500	Frederick Fleck	36
91569	Rachel Eddleman	90
91776	Bert Rupert	89
91854	Melissa Toribio	78
91856	Jeremiah Ramirez	68
91874	Felipe Avery	76
91925	Cameron Snedeker	59
91933	Mabel Beard	23
92035	Linda Curry	75
92082	Joanne Hawkinson	72
92128	Lottie Wright	23
92170	Ella Ridings	47
92237	Samuel Hyland	49
92305	Darlene Sabo	48
92417	Jimmy Ochoa	45
92624	Malcolm Mullen	65
92738	Karen Massey	43
92809	Grady Collins	58
92911	Roger Wages	47
92918	Deanna Medina	50
92969	Sarah Ashbaugh	92
93130	Bridget Alvarez	26
93158	Derek Macaulay	50
93271	Miguel Wojtowicz	38
93348	George Rojas	26
93367	Victor Hoover	43
93443	Eugenia Sierra	31
93489	Sharon Toussaint	50
93651	Hubert Allen	21
93668	John Brown	64
93766	Julianne Welch	34
94243	Hiram Gauthier	67
94491	Deborah White	89
94531	Ruby Martinez	68
94637	Pamela Magill	58

TICKET	NAME	AGE
94665	Federico Granata	26
95011	Ollie Edge	26
95338	Alex Camacho	64
95401	Jamal Perry	36
95455	Richard Stearns	34
95620	Edgar Callejas	54
95630	Sadie Finlayson	89
95843	Charles Espinal	45
95880	Jose Eriksen	19
95905	Fred Stokes	36
95994	Rafael Caraveo	61
96035	Gilbert Lybarger	38
96165	Leslie Turnage	79
96198	Kelly Cox	65
96323	Carol Freeland	67
96516	Dennis Frisch	47
96864	Cecil Bingham	64
97095	Ella Sosa	58
97300	Hugh Anderson	85
97319	Amelia Hayes	87
97426	Tracy Gresham	53
97458	Fabian Cedillo	69
97495	Merlin Matute	83
97659	James Barrie	90
97673	Marilyn Kimble	81
97720	Jill Conrad	62
97795	Jack Helmuth	63
97981	Annette Bates	71
98058	Harris Tune	59
98648	Ebony Rhone	78
98825	April Koch	36
98827	Joyce Hocker	76
98937	Rita Lohse	27
99009	Holly Runyon	67
99027	Frances Lee	82
99168	Chris Beaulieu	76
99237	Nadia Rickert	74
99257	Janice Corriveau	27
99411	Leticia Somers	91
99459	Jackie Shoffner	41
99472	Pamela Hardin	46
99607	Curtis Lubbers	81
99794	Jimmie Beaudry	20
99953	Kenneth Hulsey	81

CHECKING TABLES

How many names should be left on each register page after each clue. Find your page in the first column. The tables stop at Clue 2. After that, so few names are left that a table would point straight at the finalists; the checkpoints give the total for the whole register instead.

PAGE	Clue 1	Clue 2
14	31	0
15	32	11
16	31	27
17	21	13
18	32	22
19	25	15
20	31	17
21	30	18
22	21	13
23	27	18
24	32	20
25	42	31
26	32	22
27	34	15
28	28	21

PART TWO: THE CASE FILES

Well done, detective. Three finalists are left, and every one of them matches every clue. Now find out which of them killed Captain Silas Merrow.

The purser's staff copied the records in a hurry and wrote down only the **last three digits** of each ticket, never names. So first write down your three finalists and their full ticket numbers in the box below. Many other numbers appear in the files: they belong to people you crossed out in Part One, so you can ignore them. When a record's three digits match one of your finalists, it belongs to that finalist: the police have already checked.

The passenger records are **not complete**, so a finalist who is missing from them has done nothing wrong. What counts is a record that puts a finalist somewhere else at the wrong time. The last two files, for the paperweights and for the key cards, are complete lists.

The killer must pass all **three tests** on the next page. Each of the other finalists fails at least one.

MY FINALISTS

Ticket _____ Name _____

Ticket _____ Name _____

Ticket _____ Name _____

THE THREE TESTS

TEST 1: OPPORTUNITY

The captain was attacked in his cabin at some moment between **9:05 and 9:15 PM**. The killer had to be in the Captain's Cabin at some point in that window, even if only for a moment.

How to check it: Look up the last three digits of each finalist's ticket in the passenger records (Files A to G). If a finalist was seen somewhere else at a time that makes it **impossible** to reach the Captain's Cabin between 9:05 and 9:15, using the walking times on the map, that finalist fails this test. Walking times are the same in both directions.

Example: someone seen in the Library at 9:10 PM could not have been in the Captain's Cabin at any moment between 9:05 and 9:15: the Library is 8 minutes' walk away.

And the other way around: someone seen on the Promenade Deck at 9:30 PM could easily have been in the Captain's Cabin at 9:10, because the deck is only 5 minutes away.

TEST 2: MEANS

The captain was struck with a **brass anchor paperweight**, sold that night only at the Purser's Shop. The killer bought one.

How to check it: Look for the last three digits of each finalist's ticket in the shop's sales book (File H). A finalist who is not in it fails this test.

TEST 3: ACCESS

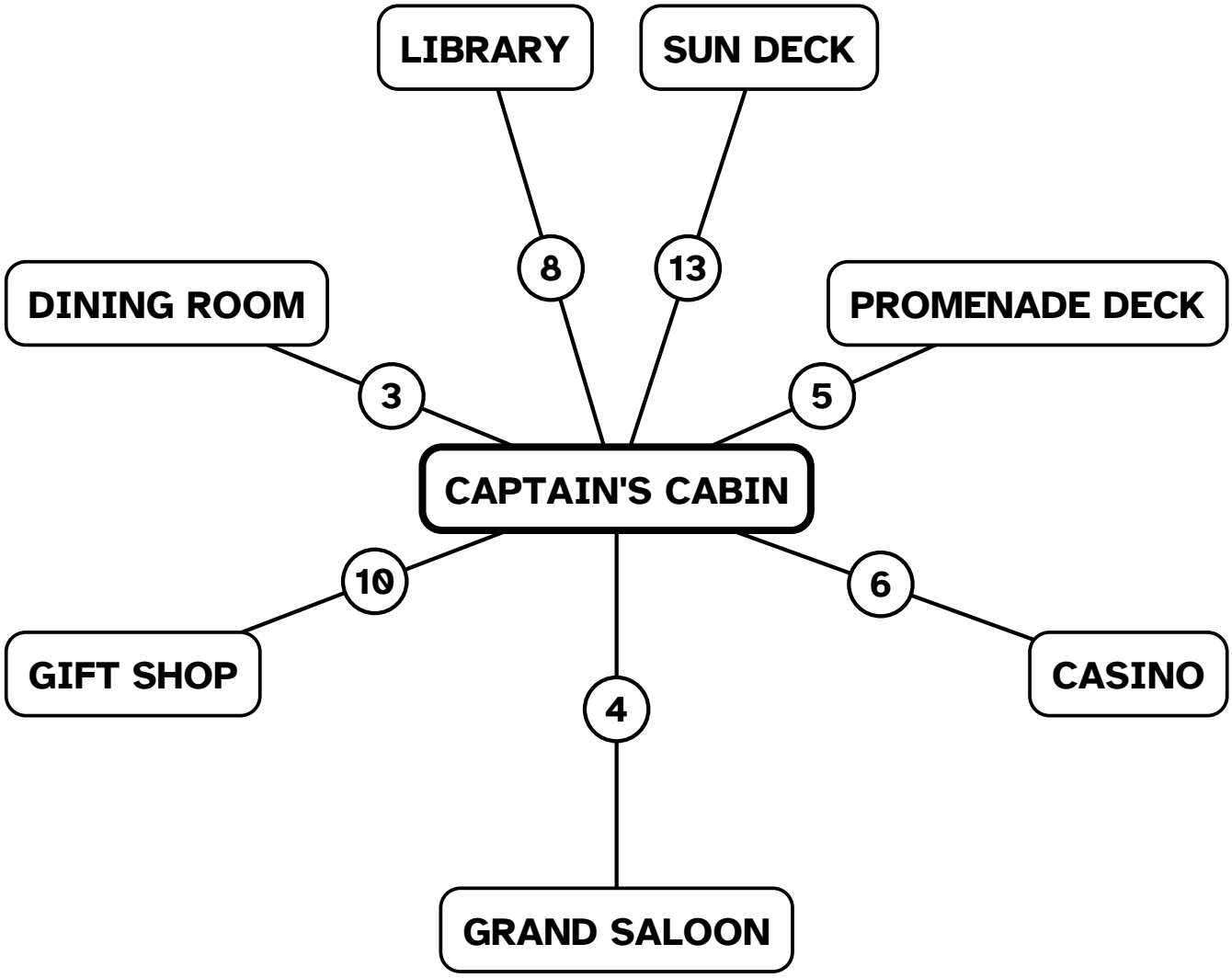
The corridor to the Captain's Cabin has a locked door, and only a red **Captain's Table key card** opens it. The killer had one.

How to check it: Look for the last three digits of each finalist's ticket in the list of red key cards (File I). A finalist who is not on it fails this test.

Stuck? There are gentle hints for every test on page 39.

MAP OF THE MAGNOLIA QUEEN

The numbers show the walking time, in minutes, from each part of the boat to the Captain's Cabin.



Walking time to the Captain's Cabin:

Dining Room	3 min	Library	8 min
Grand Saloon	4 min	Gift Shop	10 min
Promenade Deck	5 min	Sun Deck	13 min
Casino	6 min		

FILE A · Dining Room Wine Orders

Some of the wine orders from the Dining Room, with the time and the ticket. The rest were paid in cash.

6:35 PM	ending 453	9:08 PM	ending 774
8:08 PM	ending 723	9:52 PM	ending 340
8:24 PM	ending 273	10:49 PM	ending 370
8:44 PM	ending 273	11:22 PM	ending 300

FILE B · Grand Saloon Dance Cards

Dance cards handed in at the Grand Saloon, with the time and the ticket. Not everyone danced.

6:18 PM	ending 300	8:26 PM	ending 673
7:10 PM	ending 297	9:02 PM	ending 950

FILE C · Promenade Deck Lemonade Stand

Receipts from the lemonade stand on the Promenade Deck, with the time and the ticket. Cash sales had no receipt.

7:13 PM	ending 453	10:35 PM	ending 673
7:53 PM	ending 142	10:46 PM	ending 673
8:07 PM	ending 472	11:15 PM	ending 072
8:23 PM	ending 723		

FILE D · Casino Chip Desk

Chips bought at the casino desk, with the time and the ticket. Only the card payments were written down.

6:37 PM	ending 297	10:22 PM	ending 774
6:49 PM	ending 340	11:00 PM	ending 340
9:57 PM	ending 554	11:17 PM	ending 750

FILE E · Library Sign-In Sheet

Passengers who borrowed a book signed in with the time and their ticket. Not everyone bothered to sign.

6:22 PM	ending 520	10:57 PM	ending 300
7:21 PM	ending 072	11:02 PM	ending 297
9:19 PM	ending 520	11:15 PM	ending 554
9:54 PM	ending 774	11:26 PM	ending 453

FILE F · Gift Shop Receipts

Receipts from the Gift Shop, with the time and the ticket. Cash sales had no receipt.

7:11 PM	ending 750	10:08 PM	ending 142
8:22 PM	ending 072		

FILE G · Sun Deck Blanket Loans

Passengers who borrowed a blanket on the Sun Deck were noted with the time and their ticket.

6:46 PM	ending 472	9:09 PM	ending 900
7:26 PM	ending 370	9:11 PM	ending 363
9:08 PM	ending 472	10:21 PM	ending 723
9:08 PM	ending 554	11:01 PM	ending 950
9:09 PM	ending 840	11:16 PM	ending 840

FILE H · Purser's Shop Sales Book

Every ticket, by its last three digits, that bought a brass anchor paperweight on Saturday night. This list is complete.

ending 023	ending 443	ending 760
ending 053	ending 472	ending 774
ending 072	ending 554	ending 840
ending 254	ending 673	ending 900
ending 273	ending 700	ending 950
ending 274	ending 720	ending 970
ending 340	ending 723	ending 972
ending 363	ending 750	

FILE I · Captain's Table Key Cards

Every ticket, by its last three digits, that was given a red Captain's Table key card. This list is complete.

ending 023	ending 072	ending 254
ending 053	ending 142	ending 273

continued on the next page

FILE I (continued)

ending 274
ending 297
ending 300
ending 363
ending 370
ending 443
ending 453
ending 554
ending 673
ending 700
ending 720
ending 723
ending 750
ending 760
ending 774
ending 950
ending 970
ending 972

THE DEDUCTION SHEET

Write each finalist's ticket number, then put a check mark if they pass the test and an X if they fail it. The killer is the only one with three check marks.

TICKET	TEST 1 Opportunity	TEST 2 Means	TEST 3 Access
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐

The killer is ticket number _____

Now work out your Verdict Code on page 42 to check your answer.

HINTS, PART A: A GENTLE NUDGE

Read these first. Each one tells you where to look, not what you will find.

TEST 1: OPPORTUNITY

Hint 1-A. Work with one finalist at a time. Find every record with the last three digits of their ticket in the records (Files A to G), and note the place and the time.

TEST 2: MEANS

Hint 2-A. Look for the last three digits of each finalist's ticket in File H. The list is in number order.

TEST 3: ACCESS

Hint 3-A. Look for the last three digits of each finalist's ticket in File I. The list is in number order.

HINTS, PART B: A STRONGER PUSH

Each hint tells you how many of your finalists fail that test.

TEST 1: OPPORTUNITY

Hint 1-B. Exactly 1 of your finalists fails this test.

TEST 2: MEANS

Hint 2-B. Exactly 1 of your finalists fails this test.

TEST 3: ACCESS

Hint 3-B. Exactly 1 of your finalists fails this test.

HINTS, PART C: THE ANSWERS

Only read this page if you are truly stuck. It explains which finalists fail each test, and why.

TEST 1: OPPORTUNITY

Hint 1-C. The finalist whose ticket ends in 472 was on the Sun Deck at 9:08 PM. The quickest walk from the Sun Deck to the Captain's Cabin takes 13 minutes, so they could not have been there at any moment between 9:05 PM and 9:15 PM.

TEST 2: MEANS

Hint 2-C. The finalist whose ticket ends in 370 is not in File H.

TEST 3: ACCESS

Hint 3-C. The finalist whose ticket ends in 472 is not in File I.

YOUR VERDICT CODE

When only one suspect is left, work out their **Verdict Code**. It is the only way to check your answer: the solution is never printed as a name anywhere in this book.

Step 1. Give every letter of the suspect's first and last name its number from the table below, and add them all up.

Step 2. Add the **last three digits** of the suspect's ticket number.

Step 3. Look up the total in the Verdict Table on the next page.

A	**B**	**C**	**D**	**E**	**F**	**G**	**H**	**I**	**J**	**K**	**L**	**M**
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
N	**O**	**P**	**Q**	**R**	**S**	**T**	**U**	**V**	**W**	**X**	**Y**	**Z**
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

Example (not a real suspect): **Ada Bell**, ticket **31207**.

Ada = A 1 + D 4 + A 1 = 6. Bell = B 2 + E 5 + L 12 + L 12 = 31. Name total = 6 + 31 = 37.

Last three digits of the ticket: 207. Verdict Code = 37 + 207 = **244**.

THE VERDICT TABLE

Find your Verdict Code in the list. If it is not here, check your adding up first, then go back to your last checkpoint.

103 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

125 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

134 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

136 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

144 Not quite. Check Clues 3 and 5 again.

156 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

310 Not quite. Check Clue 2 again.

314 Not quite. Check Clue 7 again.

316 Not quite. Check Clue 10 again.

321 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

372 Not quite. Check Clue 7 again.

387 Not quite. Check Clue 10 again.

401 Not quite. Check Clue 9 again.

429 Not quite. Check Clue 3 again.

451 Not quite. Check Clue 7 again.

472 Not quite. Check Clue 3 again.

481 So close! This finalist fails Test 2 (Means). Check it again.

505 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

533 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

556 Not quite. Check Clue 6 again.

574 So close! This finalist fails Test 1 (Opportunity) and Test 3 (Access). Check it again.

627 Not quite. Check Clue 8 again.

644 Not quite. Check Clue 4 again.

651 Not quite. Check Clue 5 again.

654 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

659 Not quite. Check Clue 1 again.

709 Not quite. Check Clue 2 again.

759 Not quite. Check Clue 2 again.

809 Not quite. Check Clue 9 again.

838 Not quite. Check Clues 2 and 9 again.

853 Not quite. Check Clue 8 again.

865 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

878 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

885 Not quite. Check Clue 3 again.

929 Not quite. Check Clue 8 again.

951 Not quite. Check Clue 3 again.

1029 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1058 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1100 CASE CLOSED! Turn to page 47.

1125 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1126 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1167 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1179 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1180 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

STOP, DETECTIVE

Do not turn the page until the Verdict Table says **CASE CLOSED**.
The end of the story is on the next page.

CASE CLOSED

The old log turned up the next morning, wrapped in oilcloth inside a life ring locker at the stern, with the captain's notes folded between its pages.

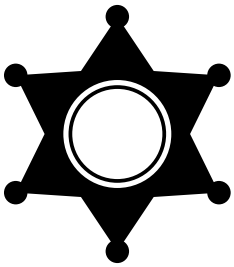
The notes explained everything. The "lost" log that had made the Magnolia Queen famous was a clever fake, and the captain had finally proved it. The person who had sold it to him years ago was on board that night, and was not going to let the truth come out in front of eight hundred passengers.

The Magnolia Queen still sails out of Natchez every Saturday night. The captain's wheel hangs in the Grand Saloon now, with a small brass plate underneath: "Forty years, and an honest log."

Eight hundred passengers, ten clues, three tests and one pen. You found the one person who could have done it.

Case closed. Well done, detective.

The killer was: _____



CERTIFICATE OF DETECTION

This certifies that

_____

cracked the case of

Death on the Magnolia Queen

and found the one killer among 800 suspects.

Date case closed _____

Days on the case _____

_____

Chief of Detectives



THANK YOU, DETECTIVE

Thank you for spending your time with this case. We build every book so that it is fair, clear and easy on the eyes, and we hope it gave you some happy hours with a pen in your hand.

If you enjoyed it, there are more cases waiting for you, all in the same large, clear print.

THE CROSS OUT THE KILLER SERIES

LEVEL 1

Murder at the Antiques Fair

Rookie · Easy · 3,000 suspects

LEVEL 2

Death at the Model Railroad Show

Detective · Medium · 5,000 suspects

LEVEL 3

Murder at the Ballpark

Lieutenant · Hard · 8,000 suspects